

GITHUB WEBSITE PUBLISHING GUIDE

From Zero to Live Website — Beginner → Pro

Using Manus AI • GitHub • GitHub Pages • Vercel • Custom Domains

Free Version | 2025 Edition

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CHAPTER 1

What You Need Before You Start

Tools, accounts, and concepts explained simply

Think of publishing a website like printing a book and putting it in a library. You need: (1) the book — your website files; (2) a library — a hosting service; (3) an address — your domain name. This guide covers all three using free tools.

What You Need	Why	Cost
A computer / phone	To access GitHub and upload files	Free
Internet connection	To upload and manage your site	Your plan
GitHub account	Free hosting, version control	FREE
Manus AI account	To build your website with AI	Free tier
Vercel account (opt.)	Faster hosting, better free plan	FREE
Custom domain (opt.)	Professional address like yourname.com	\$10-15/yr
Git (software)	Needed only for advanced uploads	FREE

Key Concepts You'll Hear:

- **Repository (repo):** A folder on GitHub that stores all your website files.
- **Branch:** A version of your repo. 'main' is the default live branch.
- **Commit:** Saving a change — like pressing Save in Google Docs.
- **Push:** Sending your saved changes from your computer to GitHub.
- **Deploy:** Making your website visible to the public on the internet.
- **DNS:** The internet's phone book. Connects your domain to your host.
- **CNAME:** A DNS record that points your domain to another address.

■ TIP

You do NOT need to know how to code to follow this guide. Manus AI generates all the code for you.

CHAPTER 2

Setting Up GitHub (Free Account)

Create your account and install Git in under 10 minutes

1 Create a Free GitHub Account

Go to <https://github.com> and click **Sign up**.

- Enter your email address → choose a username (this appears in your site URL) → set a password.
- Verify your email address when GitHub sends you a confirmation link.
- On the plan screen, choose **Free** — it includes unlimited public repos and GitHub Pages hosting.

2 Install Git on Your Computer (Optional — for advanced users)

Git lets you push changes from your computer. Beginners can skip this and upload files through the browser.

```
Windows: Download from https://git-scm.com/download/win
Mac: Open Terminal → xcode-select --install
Linux: sudo apt install git
```

After install, open Terminal / Command Prompt and run:

```
git config --global user.name "Your Name"
git config --global user.email "you@email.com"
```

3 Explore Your GitHub Dashboard

Once logged in you will see:

- **Repositories** tab — all your project folders.
- **+ New** button (top right) — creates a new repository.
- **Profile icon** → **Settings** — account preferences.

■ **TIP** Your GitHub username becomes part of your free site address: `username.github.io` — choose it carefully!

■ **NOTE** Do NOT make your repository private if you want free GitHub Pages hosting. Free accounts need public repos for Pages.

CHAPTER 3

Getting Your Website Files from Manus AI

Export, download, and understand your generated site

Manus AI is an AI platform that builds complete, working websites for you. Once you describe what you want, it generates HTML, CSS, JavaScript and image files. Your job is simply to download those files and upload them to GitHub.

1 Build Your Website in Manus AI

1. Log in at <https://manus.ai> (create a free account if needed).
2. In the chat / prompt box, describe your website clearly. Example:

```
"Build me a personal portfolio website with a home page, about page,
contact form, and dark theme. Make it mobile-friendly."
```

3. Wait for Manus to generate the site. You will see a preview on screen.
4. Review the preview — if you want changes, type your instructions.

2 Download / Export Your Files

Look for an **Export** or **Download** button in the Manus AI interface.

- Choose **Download as ZIP** — this gives you a .zip file with all your site files.
- Save the ZIP to a folder on your computer you can easily find, e.g., [Desktop/mywebsite/](#)
- Right-click the ZIP file → **Extract All** (Windows) or double-click (Mac).

3 Understand the File Structure

After extracting you should see files like:

```
mywebsite/
index.html ← The HOMEPAGE (most important file)
about.html
contact.html
style.css ← The visual design
script.js ← Interactive features
images/ ← Photos and icons
```

IMPORTANT: The file named [index.html](#) is your homepage. GitHub Pages always looks for this file first.

■ **TIP** If Manus AI gives you a single HTML file with everything inside it, that is perfectly fine — upload it as-is and name it `index.html`.

CHAPTER 4

Creating Your GitHub Repository

The folder on GitHub that will hold your website

1 Create a New Repository

1. Log into GitHub and click the **+ New** button or go to github.com/new
2. Fill in the form:

Field	What to Enter	Why
Repository name	username.github.io OR my-website	For GitHub Pages, the name matters
Description	Optional — describe your site	Good for organisation
Visibility	Select: Public	Required for free hosting
Add README	Check this box	Creates the repo properly
.gitignore	Leave as None	Not needed for websites
License	Optional	Skip for personal sites

Two Naming Strategies:

Option A — User Site (easiest): Name your repo exactly yourusername.github.io (replace yourusername with your actual GitHub username). Your site will be live at <https://yourusername.github.io>.

Option B — Project Site: Name it anything, e.g., [my-portfolio](https://yourusername.github.io/my-portfolio). Your site will be at <https://yourusername.github.io/my-portfolio>.

2 Click 'Create Repository'

GitHub creates your repository and shows you an empty folder with just a README.md file. You are now ready to upload your website files.

CHAPTER 5

Uploading Your Files to GitHub

Browser upload method (no coding required)

There are two ways to upload files: via the browser (easy) or via Git commands (powerful). We cover both. Start with the browser method.

METHOD 1 — Upload via Browser (Recommended for Beginners)

1 Open Your Repository on GitHub

Go to github.com/yourusername/your-repo-name in your browser.

2 Upload Files

Click **Add file** → **Upload files**.

- Drag all your extracted website files into the upload box, **OR** click 'choose your files'.
- Select ALL files and folders from your extracted Manus AI ZIP.
- Wait for the upload progress bar to complete.

3 Commit (Save) Your Files

Scroll down to the **Commit changes** section:

- In the message box, type something like: `Add website files`
- Leave everything else as default.
- Click the green **Commit changes** button.

■ Your files are now saved on GitHub!

METHOD 2 — Upload via Git Commands (Advanced)

Open Terminal / Command Prompt on your computer:

```
# Step 1 — Clone the empty repo to your computer
git clone https://github.com/yourusername/your-repo-name.git

# Step 2 — Move into the folder
cd your-repo-name

# Step 3 — Copy your website files into this folder manually
# (use File Explorer / Finder to drag files in)

# Step 4 — Tell Git to track all new files
git add .

# Step 5 — Save (commit) the changes
git commit -m "Add website files"

# Step 6 — Send files to GitHub
git push origin main
```

■ TIP

Use Method 1 (browser) when you want to update one or two files quickly. Use Method 2 (Git) when you're making frequent changes or working on big projects.

CHAPTER 6

Enabling GitHub Pages (Free Live Hosting)

Turn your uploaded files into a live website in 2 minutes

GitHub Pages is a completely free service that takes files from your repository and publishes them as a live website. Zero cost, zero server management.

1 Go to Repository Settings

In your repository, click the **Settings** tab (top menu, rightmost option).

2 Find the Pages Section

In the left sidebar, scroll down and click **Pages** (under the 'Code and automation' section).

3 Configure the Source

Under **Build and deployment** → **Source**, select **Deploy from a branch**.

- Branch: select `main` (or `master` if that's what your repo uses).
- Folder: select `/ (root)` — this means use the top-level folder.
- Click **Save**.

4 Wait for Deployment

GitHub will show a yellow spinner while it builds. Refresh the page after 1–2 minutes. When it turns **green**, your site is live!

A green box will show your live URL: <https://yourusername.github.io/your-repo>

5 Visit Your Live Website

Click the URL shown in the Pages settings. Your Manus AI website is now live on the internet — accessible to anyone in the world!

■ **NOTE** It can take up to 10 minutes for GitHub Pages to deploy the first time. If the site doesn't load immediately, wait a few minutes and try again.

■ **TIP** Every time you commit (save) new files to GitHub, your website updates automatically within 1–3 minutes. No manual republishing needed!

CHAPTER 7

Connecting a Custom Domain

Replace `username.github.io` with `yourbrand.com`

A custom domain (like www.yourname.com) makes your site look professional. You need to buy a domain (about \$10–15/year) from a registrar like Namecheap, GoDaddy, or Google Domains.

1 Buy a Domain Name

Go to namecheap.com or porkbun.com (cheapest options). Search for your domain → Add to cart → Purchase.

2 Add DNS Records at Your Registrar

Log in to your domain registrar. Find **DNS Settings** / **Advanced DNS** / **Manage DNS** for your domain.

For the **APEX / root domain** (e.g., `yourname.com`), add these **A records**:

```
Type Host Value
A @ 185.199.108.153
A @ 185.199.109.153
A @ 185.199.110.153
A @ 185.199.111.153
```

For **`www.yourname.com`**, add a **CNAME record**:

```
Type Host Value
CNAME www yourusername.github.io
```

3 Add Your Domain in GitHub Pages Settings

Go to your repo → Settings → Pages → **Custom domain** field.

Type your domain (e.g., www.yourname.com) → click **Save**.

GitHub will verify the DNS. A green checkmark means it worked!

4 Enable HTTPS (Free SSL Certificate)

Still in Pages settings, tick **Enforce HTTPS**. This gives your site the padlock  in browsers — essential for Google ranking.

■ **NOTE** DNS changes can take 24–48 hours to fully propagate worldwide. Your site may show as unreachable during this time — this is normal.

CHAPTER 8

Deploying on Vercel (Free & Faster Alternative)

Better performance, automatic HTTPS, and instant deployments

Vercel is a free hosting platform that connects directly to your GitHub repository. When you push changes to GitHub, Vercel automatically redeploys your site. It's faster than GitHub Pages and has a more generous free tier.

1 Create a Vercel Account

Go to <https://vercel.com> → click **Sign Up** → choose **Continue with GitHub** — this links both accounts automatically.

2 Import Your GitHub Repository

On the Vercel dashboard, click **Add New...** → **Project**.

- Vercel lists all your GitHub repos. Find your website repo and click **Import**.
- Vercel auto-detects static HTML sites. Leave all settings as default.
- Click **Deploy**.

3 Wait for Deployment (30 seconds)

Vercel shows a build log. When it says **Congratulations!**, your site is live at a Vercel URL like [your-repo.vercel.app](#).

4 Add a Custom Domain to Vercel

In your Vercel project → **Settings** → **Domains** → type your domain → **Add**.

Vercel shows you the DNS records to add at your registrar (same process as Chapter 7 but using Vercel's specific values). Follow the on-screen instructions.

Feature	GitHub Pages	Vercel (Free)
Cost	Free	Free
Custom domain	■ Yes	■ Yes
HTTPS / SSL	■ Yes	■ Yes
Deploy speed	1–5 minutes	~30 seconds
Deploy on push	■ Yes	■ Yes
Bandwidth limit	100 GB/month	100 GB/month
Build support	Static HTML only	Static + React, Next.js
Analytics	■ No	■ Basic analytics

CHAPTER 9

Checking If Your Website Is Live

Verify your site loads correctly from everywhere

1 Direct Browser Test

Type your URL directly into a browser:

- GitHub Pages: <https://yourusername.github.io> or <https://yourusername.github.io/repo-name>
- Custom domain: <https://www.yourdomain.com>

If you see your website — **congratulations, it's live!** ■

2 Test from Multiple Devices & Networks

Your site might be cached on your device. Test from:

- A different browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari)
- Your mobile phone (on mobile data, not the same WiFi)
- Ask a friend in another city to visit the URL

3 Use Online Checking Tools

These free tools check your site from multiple global locations:

- <https://downforeveryoneorjustme.com> — quick up/down check
- <https://www.whatsmydns.net> — check DNS propagation worldwide
- <https://tools.pingdom.com> — full speed and availability test
- <https://pagespeed.web.dev> — Google's performance checker

4 Check GitHub Pages Build Status

If the site isn't loading, check: Repo → **Actions** tab → look for a workflow run. Green = deployed. Red = error (click to see error message).

Common 'Not Loading' Reasons:

- **404 Not Found:** Your index.html file is missing or named incorrectly (e.g., Index.html).
- **Site not enabled:** You forgot to enable GitHub Pages in Settings.
- **Wrong branch:** Pages is set to deploy from a branch that doesn't exist.
- **DNS not propagated:** Custom domain changes take up to 48 hours.
- **HTTPS error:** Wait 24 hours after enabling — certificate provisioning takes time.

CHAPTER 10

Getting on Google — SEO Basics

Help Google find, index, and rank your website

Your site being live and Google knowing it exists are **two different things**. Google sends 'crawlers' (bots) to discover new sites, but it can take weeks unless you tell Google directly.

1 Submit Your Site to Google Search Console

1. Go to <https://search.google.com/search-console> → Sign in with Google.
2. Click **Add property** → choose **URL prefix** → enter your full URL.
3. Verify ownership. The easiest method: download an HTML file Google provides and upload it to your GitHub repo root, then commit.
4. Once verified, click **URL Inspection** → **Request Indexing** for your homepage.

2 Create a sitemap.xml file

A sitemap tells Google every page on your site. Create a file called `sitemap.xml` and upload it to your repo:

```
https://www.yourdomain.com/  
weekly  
1.0  
  
https://www.yourdomain.com/about.html  
0.8
```

Then in Google Search Console → Sitemaps → enter `sitemap.xml` → Submit.

3 Add Meta Tags to Your HTML

In your `index.html` file, inside the section, add:

```
Your Website Name | Tagline
```

TIP

Google typically takes 1–4 weeks to index a brand new website, even after submission. Be patient. Keep adding content regularly to help ranking.

CHAPTER 11

Troubleshooting: Site Live but Not Showing on Google

Diagnose and fix why Google can't see your website

If your site loads fine in a browser but doesn't appear in Google search results, use this diagnostic checklist:

Check	How to Diagnose	Fix
Is your site indexed?	Type this in Google search: site:yourdomain.com — if results appear, missing robots.txt blocking, or site too new (under 4 weeks).	HTTPS, missing robots.txt blocking, or site too new (under 4 weeks).
Is robots.txt blocking crawlers?	Check https://yourdomain.com/robots.txt — it should NOT say "Disallow: /"	Add robots.txt file with: User-agent: * / Allow: /
Is the site slow?	Use PageSpeed Insights (pagespeed.web.dev). Score below 60	Compress images, remove unused CSS/JS. Vercel is faster than Git
Does your site have enough content?	Google won't rank pages with fewer than ~300 words of real text	Add more text content, blog posts, or descriptions to your pages.
Are there broken links?	Use https://www.brokenlinkcheck.com to scan your site.	Fix or remove any broken internal or external links.
Missing HTTPS?	Google penalises non-HTTPS sites. Check for the padlock in your browser	Enable HTTPS in GitHub Pages / Vercel settings (covered in Chapter

Create a robots.txt file — upload to your repo root:

```
User-agent: *
Allow: /
Sitemap: https://www.yourdomain.com/sitemap.xml
```

■ NOTE

Google indexing for brand new domains typically takes 4–12 weeks. There is no way to force instant ranking. Keep your content updated.

CHAPTER 12

Common Errors & How to Fix Them

Quick solutions to the most frequent problems beginners face

Error	Cause	Fix
404 Page Not Found	GitHub can't find index.html in the root of your repository.	Make sure a file named exactly index.html (lowercase) is in the root folder, not inside a subfolder.
Site shows README instead of website	No index.html file exists; GitHub falls back to README.	Upload index.html file to the repository root.
'CNAME already taken' error	Another GitHub repo is using the same custom domain.	Remove the CNAME from the old repo's Pages settings first, then add to the new one.
Mixed Content warning (HTTPS/HTTP)	Your HTML loads some resources over HTTP instead of HTTPS.	Replace all http:// links with https:// for images, CSS, and scripts.
Changes not appearing after commit	Browser cache is showing old version, or deployment is still pending.	Deploy manually: Ctrl+Shift+R (Windows) / Cmd+Shift+R (Mac). Check the Actions tab for status.
Vercel deployment failed	Build error — usually a file path issue.	Click the failed deployment → read the error log. Usually a missing file or wrong file name.
Domain not connecting after 48 hours	DNS records entered incorrectly at registrar.	Double-check A records and CNAME at your registrar match exactly what GitHub / Vercel requires.
GitHub Pages option greyed out	Repository is set to Private.	Go to Settings → General → change repository to Public. Then enable Pages.

TIP

When in doubt, check the GitHub Actions tab in your repository. The build log shows exactly what went wrong with colour-coded output.

CHAPTER 13

Beginner → Pro Roadmap

Your learning path from first deploy to advanced developer

■ BEGINNER

- ✓ Create GitHub account
- ✓ Download Manus AI website files
- ✓ Upload files via GitHub browser
- ✓ Enable GitHub Pages
- ✓ Verify site is live
- ✓ Share your URL with friends

■ INTERMEDIATE

- ✓ Install Git on your computer
- ✓ Learn basic git add / commit / push
- ✓ Connect a custom domain
- ✓ Enable HTTPS everywhere
- ✓ Submit to Google Search Console
- ✓ Add sitemap.xml and robots.txt

■ ADVANCED

- ✓ Deploy on Vercel for faster hosting
- ✓ Use GitHub Actions for automation
- ✓ Add a contact form (Formspree — free)
- ✓ Add Google Analytics (free tracking)
- ✓ Optimise site speed (PageSpeed score 90+)
- ✓ Use branches for testing changes safely

- ✓ Learn HTML/CSS to customise Manus output
- ✓ Use VS Code + Git for full workflow
- ✓ Set up CI/CD (auto-deploy pipelines)
- ✓ Add a CMS (Netlify CMS — free)
- ✓ Implement SEO content strategy
- ✓ Use GitHub Issues for project management

■ PRO**■ TIP**

Focus on completing each stage fully before moving to the next. Most beginners can reach Intermediate level in just 1 weekend of practice.

CHAPTER 14

Quick-Reference Cheat Sheet

Everything you need on one page — save or print this!

Essential URLs

GitHub	github.com
GitHub Pages docs	docs.github.com/pages
Vercel	vercel.com
Namecheap	namecheap.com
Porkbun	porkbun.com
Google Search Console	search.google.com/search-console
PageSpeed Insights	pagespeed.web.dev
DNS Checker	whatsmydns.net
Manus AI	manus.ai

Git Commands Cheat Sheet

```
git clone URL → Download repo to your computer
git add . → Stage all changed files
git commit -m "msg" → Save changes with a description
git push origin main → Upload changes to GitHub
git pull → Download latest changes from GitHub
git status → See what files have changed
git log --oneline → See commit history
```

GitHub Pages DNS Records (A Records for root domain)

```
185.199.108.153
185.199.109.153
185.199.110.153
185.199.111.153
```

Deployment Checklist

- index.html exists in repository root (lowercase!)
- Repository is set to Public
- GitHub Pages enabled in Settings → Pages
- Branch set to main, folder set to / (root)
- HTTPS enforced in Pages settings
- Custom domain DNS A records added (if using own domain)
- CNAME file or custom domain added in Pages settings
- Site verified in browser from mobile data
- Site submitted to Google Search Console
- sitemap.xml uploaded to repo root
- robots.txt uploaded to repo root

Remember: Beginner → upload files in browser. Pro → use Git commands. Both work perfectly. There is no wrong way to start!